

Πτολεμαῖος ὁ Ἀσκαλωνίτης

Ptolemy of Ascalon on the Difference of Words

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Period: Ῥωμαϊκή [Roman](#)
Dialect: Κοινή [Koine](#)
Domain: Γραμματική [Grammar](#)
Format: Πραγματεία [Treatise](#)

Ptolemy of Ascalon was a grammarian of the 2nd century BCE from the Hellenized city of Ascalon. His epithet identifies his origin, but no specific biographical details survive.

As a Hellenistic grammarian, he participated in the scholarly tradition focused on the study and preservation of the Greek language. He is credited with two lost grammatical treatises: *On the Difference of Words*, concerning synonyms or lexical distinctions, and *On Orthography*, on correct spelling.

Ptolemy's significance lies in his role within Hellenistic grammatical scholarship. His works were cited by later authorities like Athenaeus and the Suda, indicating their standing as authoritative sources on Greek vocabulary and orthography during a period of linguistic standardization.

Works (2)

- [Περὶ διαφορᾶς](#) · *On the Difference of Words* · 23 passages
- [Περὶ διαφορᾶς λέξεων](#) · *On the Difference of Words by Element* · 168 passages